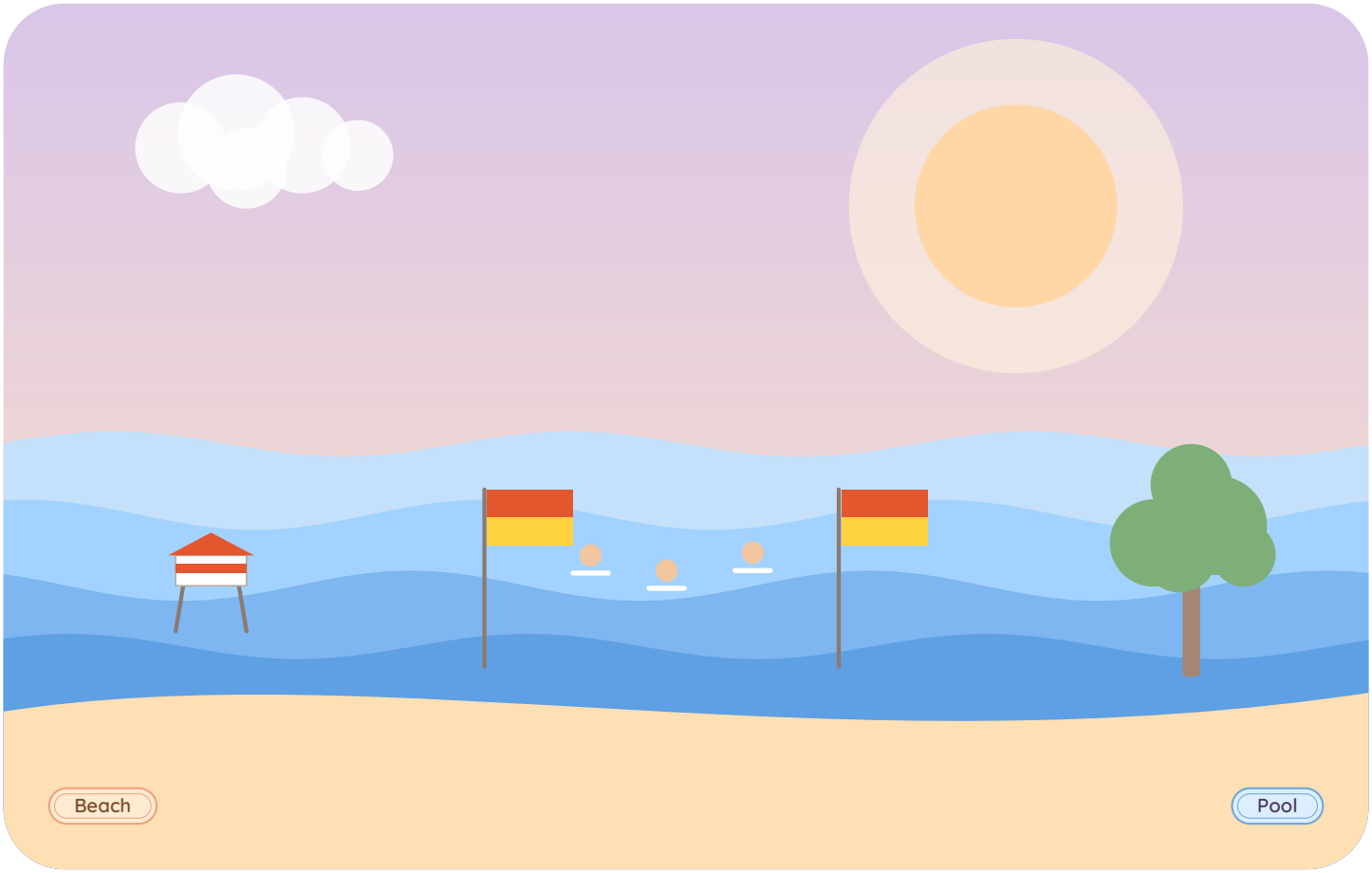


WATER SAFETY & SWIMMING IN AUSTRALIA

Year 3–4 Summer Workbook

Year 3–4 | Health and Physical Education | Australian Curriculum v9.0

Spot it. Think it through. Stay safe in, on and around the water.

INSIDE THIS WORKBOOK

- Where Australians swim and the hazards there
- Hazard Spotter in 3 levels: Support, At Standard, Extension
- Beach flags, signs and rips
- Two real-life style scenarios: river and beach
- Water and Country: First Nations perspectives
- Reach, Throw, Don't Go and calling 000
- Sun, heat and pool rules; family plan; sign design
- Skills tracker, vocabulary, answer key and rubric

Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

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Teacher Notes

Year 3–4 · Teacher Information

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Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

CURRICULUM ALIGNMENT

AC9HP4P10	investigate and apply behaviours that contribute to their own and others' health, safety, relationships and wellbeing
AC9HP4P08	describe and apply protective behaviours and help-seeking strategies in a range of online and offline situations
AC9HP4M05	participate in physical activities in natural and outdoor settings to examine factors that can influence participation
AC9HP4M01	refine and apply fundamental movement skills in new movement situations

Alignment note. Australian Curriculum v9.0 Health and Physical Education has no content description that names swimming or water safety. This pack addresses water safety through the safety, help-seeking, outdoor-settings and movement descriptors above. In Victoria, swimming and water safety is a mandated priority area in the Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 (Health and Physical Education), taught from Foundation to Level 10.

LEARNING INTENTIONS

- Name places where Australians swim and describe hazards in each.
- Spot hazards in a beach scene and explain how to reduce the risk.
- Describe how to read the beach: flags, signs and rips.
- Explain how to get help and rescue safely: Reach, Throw, Don't Go; call 000.
- Describe how First Nations knowledge of water and Country supports safe choices.
- Plan how a family can stay safe in summer around water.

SUCCESS CRITERIA (STUDENT-FRIENDLY)

- ☐ I can name five water places and a hazard for each.
- ☐ I can spot hazards and say why they are unsafe.
- ☐ I can explain what the red and yellow flags and a rip mean.
- ☐ I can say how to help someone safely and how to call 000.
- ☐ I can say one way to show respect for Country around water.
- ☐ I can make a plan to stay safe this summer.

HOW TO USE THIS PACK

- **Suggested time:** 6 to 8 lessons of 30 to 50 minutes, before or alongside your pool or beach program. Pages also work as stand-alone tasks.
- **Lesson 1:** Page 4, then one Hazard Spotter level (Page 5 Support, 6 At Standard or 7 Extension). **Lesson 2:** Page 8. **Lesson 3:** Pages 9–10. **Lesson 4:** Page 11.
- **Lesson 5:** Page 12. **Lesson 6:** Page 13. **Lessons 7–8:** Pages 14–15. Use Page 16 (skills tracker) across the pool program and Page 17 (vocabulary) throughout.
- **Printing:** student pages are 4–17. Pages 2, 3 and 18–20 are for teachers. Remove the Answer Key (Pages 18–19) before copying for students.

SAFETY AND SENSITIVITY NOTE

These worksheets support, and do not replace, qualified in-water instruction. Follow your school's swimming and water safety policy, supervision ratios and Child Safe Standards. Some students may be afraid of water, have had a frightening experience, or be unable to swim. Keep the tone calm and positive, offer choice on personal questions, and allow for cultural, religious and accessibility needs.

FIRST NATIONS PERSPECTIVES

Water is central to Country for many Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples. Acknowledge the Traditional Owners of your local area before beginning Page 11. Where possible, invite a local Aboriginal community member or use resources made by Traditional Owner groups. Avoid presenting knowledge as the same across all nations.

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Contents

Year 3–4 · Health and Physical Education

Aussie Primary Academy | Australian & Victorian Curriculum | Learn, Analyse and Practise

Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

2	**Teacher Notes** Curriculum alignment, learning intentions, how to use	Teacher page
4	**Where Do We Swim in Australia?** Pools, beaches, rivers, lakes and dams	Student page
5	**Hazard Spotter** Support Spot the hazards in a beach scene	Student page
6	**Hazard Spotter** At Standard Spot the hazards and make them safer	Student page
7	**Hazard Spotter** Extension Rank the risks and evaluate	Student page
8	**Beach Safety: Flags, Signs and Rips** Read the beach and stay between the flags	Student page
9	**Scenario 1: A Day at the River** Read, decide and explain	Student page
10	**Scenario 2: A Day at the Beach** Read, decide and explain	Student page
11	**Water and Country** First Nations perspectives and reflection	Student page
12	**Reach, Throw, Don't Go** Rescue safely and call 000	Student page
13	**Summer Safety: Sun, Heat and Pool Rules** Slip, Slop, Slap, Seek, Slide	Student page
14	**My Family Water Safety Plan** Practical planning activity	Student page
15	**Design a Water Safety Sign** Sign colours, shapes and messages	Student page
16	**My Swimming Skills Tracker** Self-assessment across the pool program	Student page
17	**Vocabulary** Key terms with student-friendly definitions	Student page
18–19	**Teacher Copy: Answers and Teaching Support** Answer Key, misconceptions, re-teach	Teacher page
20	**Marking Rubric** Simple 4-level rubric out of 24	Teacher page

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Where Do We Swim in Australia?

Year 3–4 · Water Environments

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Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	name places where Australians swim and describe one hazard for each.
KEY IDEA	Australia has pools, beaches, rivers, lakes and dams. Each place has different **hazards**. A hazard is something that could hurt you. Knowing the hazards helps us stay safe.
WORKED MODEL	Place: river. Hazard: fast water and hidden logs. Safe choice: stay out unless a trusted adult says it is safe.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ name five water places ☐ describe a hazard ☐ choose a safe action

Water places in Australia

Pool	Slippery edges, deep water, and no lifeguard at some pools.
Beach	Rips, big waves and hot sun. Swim between the red and yellow flags.
River	Fast water, cold water and hidden logs and rocks.
Lake	Deep water drops off suddenly. Weeds can tangle legs.
Dam	Very cold, deep water. Muddy sides are slippery.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. Name two places where Australians swim.

2. Write the hazard letter next to each place. **A** fast water **B** rips **C** very cold, deep water

River ☐ Beach ☐ Dam ☐

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

3. Which water place near you do you visit most? Name one hazard there and one safe choice.

C. THINK ABOUT IT

4. Write one safety rule that works at any water place.

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can name water places and their hazards.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Hazard Spotter

Year 3–4 · Support

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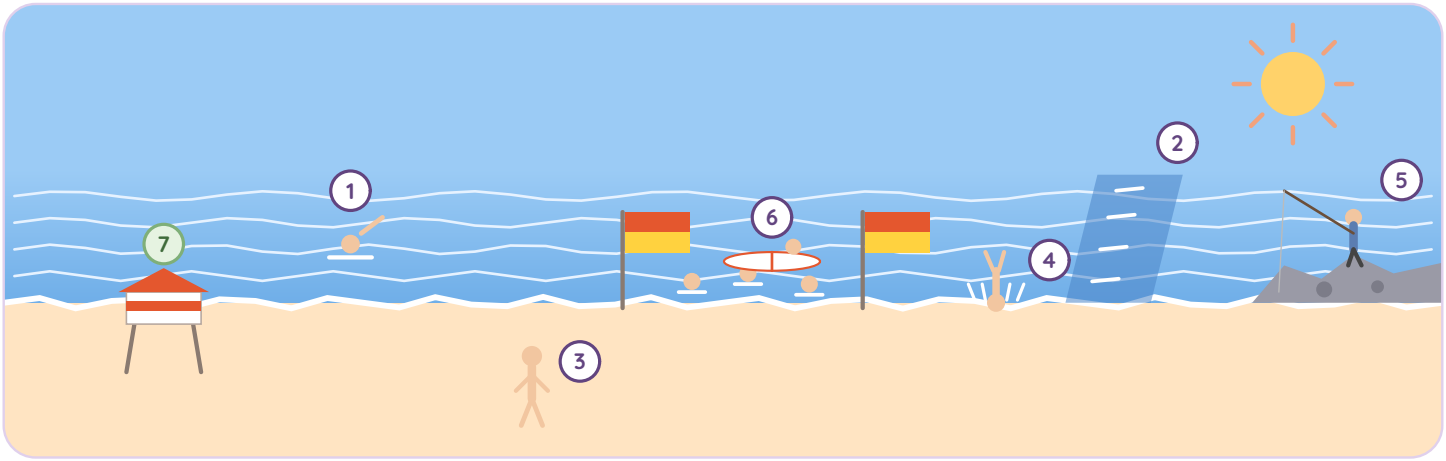
Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	find hazards in a beach scene and say why they are unsafe.
KEY IDEA	A **hazard** is something that could hurt you. Spotting hazards early helps us make safe choices.
WORKED MODEL	Hazard: no hat in hot sun. Why unsafe: skin can burn. Safe choice: wear a hat and sit in the shade.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ find hazards in the scene ☐ use the word bank ☐ say why each is unsafe



A. IDENTIFY — write each hazard from the word bank next to its number (marker 7 is safe)

swimmer outside the flags · rip current · no hat or shade · diving into shallow water · rock fishing, no lifejacket

1. _____ It is unsafe because _____
2. _____ It is unsafe because _____
3. _____ It is unsafe because _____
4. _____ It is unsafe because _____
5. _____ It is unsafe because _____
6. _____ It is unsafe because _____

B. SAFE FEATURE

Marker 7 shows the _____ It helps because _____

1. Write one rule you will follow at the beach.

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can find hazards and say why they are unsafe.

Circle one: independently · with one reminder · with support

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Hazard Spotter

Year 3–4 · At Standard

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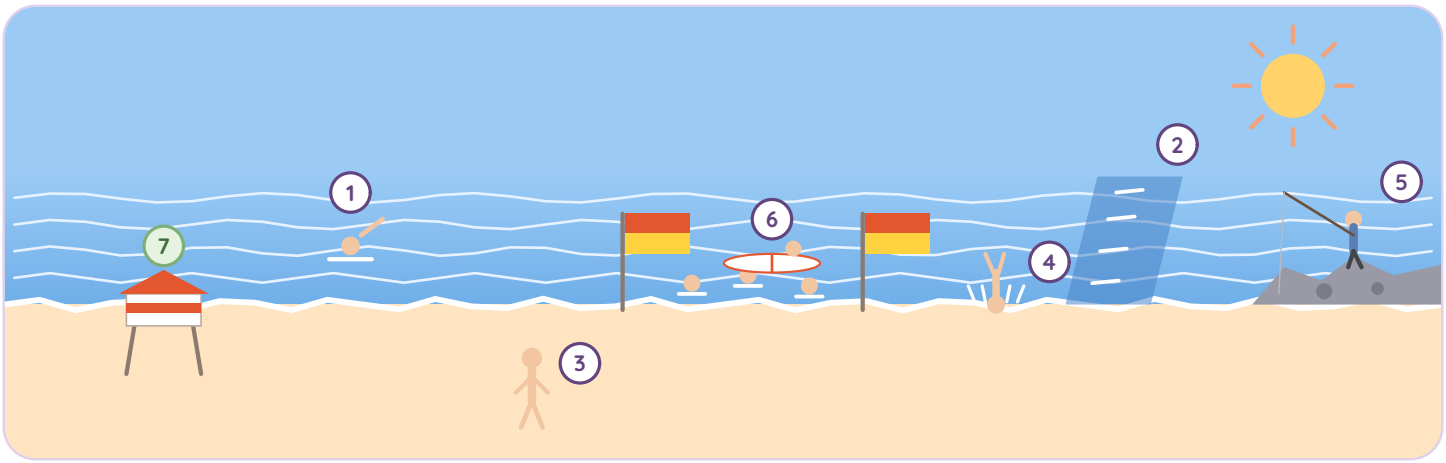
Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	spot hazards in a beach scene and explain how to make each one safer.
KEY IDEA	Good safety answers say **what** the hazard is, **why** it is unsafe and **how** to fix it.
WORKED MODEL	Hazard: swimmer outside the flags. Why: lifeguards cannot see them quickly. Safer: swim between the red and yellow flags.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ name each hazard ☐ explain the risk ☐ suggest a safer choice



A. HAZARDS AND SAFER CHOICES — complete the table for markers 1 to 6

#	HAZARD	WHY IS IT UNSAFE? HOW CAN IT BE SAFER?
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		

B. REASON

1. Which hazard do you think is the most dangerous? Explain why.

2. Marker 7 shows a safe feature. Name it and explain how it helps.

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain hazards and suggest safer choices.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Hazard Spotter

Year 3–4 · Extension

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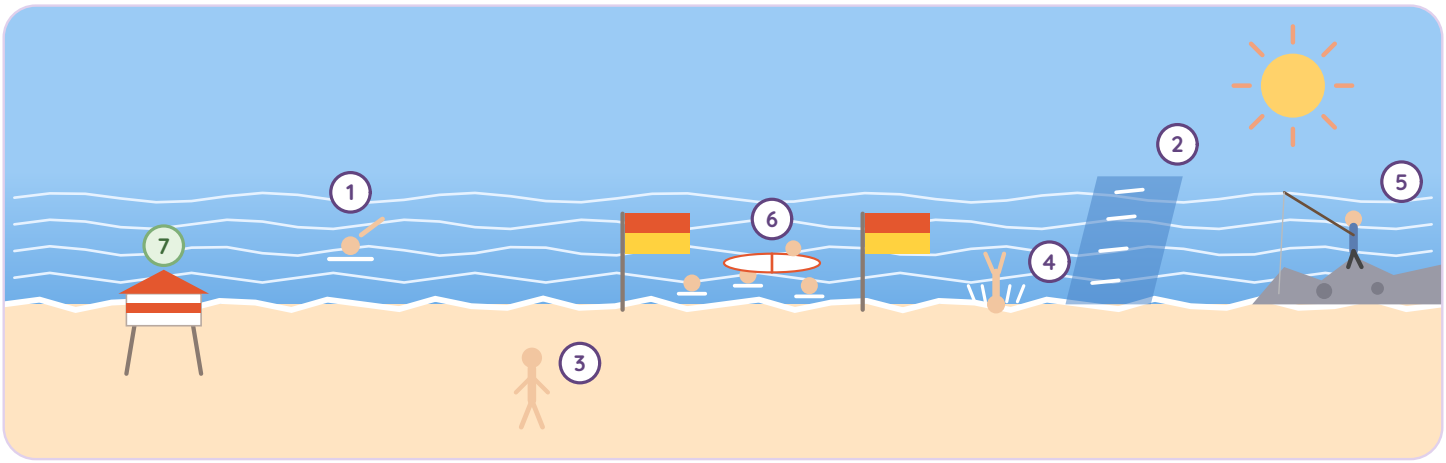
Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	rank beach hazards by risk and evaluate how well safety measures work.
KEY IDEA	**Risk** combines how likely harm is and how serious it could be. A hazard that is likely and serious is the highest risk. Safety measures reduce risk but do not remove it.
WORKED MODEL	A rip is likely to catch people in the water and can be life-threatening, so it ranks higher than no hat, which is common but less likely to cause a life-threatening emergency.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ rank by likelihood and seriousness
- ☐ justify my ranking
- ☐ evaluate safety measures



A. RANK THE RISKS — write 1 (highest risk) to 6 (lowest risk), then justify

1	☐	Hazard: _____	Why this rank?	_____
2	☐	Hazard: _____	Why this rank?	_____
3	☐	Hazard: _____	Why this rank?	_____
4	☐	Hazard: _____	Why this rank?	_____
5	☐	Hazard: _____	Why this rank?	_____
6	☐	Hazard: _____	Why this rank?	_____

B. REASON AND EVALUATE

1. Choose two hazards that could combine to cause a serious emergency. Explain how.

2. The red and yellow flags do not remove every risk. Evaluate how well they protect swimmers.

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can rank risks and evaluate safety measures.

Circle one: independently · with one reminder · with support

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Beach Safety: Flags, Signs and Rips

Year 3–4 · Read the Beach

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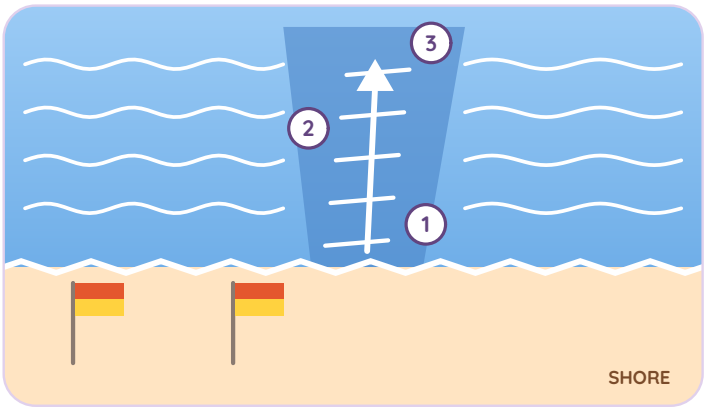
Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	explain what beach flags mean and how to recognise and respond to a rip.
KEY IDEA	Red and yellow flags show where lifeguards are watching. Swim between them. A **rip** is fast water that pulls away from the beach. If you are caught, stay calm, float and wave an arm for help.
WORKED MODEL	Look at the water. See a darker channel, foam moving out and fewer waves breaking? Do not go in. Swim at a patrolled beach between the flags.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ read the flags ☐ spot a rip ☐ say what to do if caught



Beach flags

Swim between these flags. Lifeguards are watching.

Beach closed. Do not swim.

Surf craft area. Swimmers keep out.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

Diagram: 1 darker water 2 foam moving out 3 gap in the waves

1. What do the red and yellow flags mean?

2. Look at the diagram. Name two signs that show a rip.

3. Fill the gaps: If I am caught in a rip I stay calm, **f**_ _ _ _ on my back and wave an **a**_ _.

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

4. Why is it safer to swim at a patrolled beach?

C. THINK ABOUT IT

5. A friend wants to swim near the rocks, far from the flags. What will you say?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can read the beach and respond safely to a rip.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Scenario 1: A Day at the River

Year 3–4 · Inland Water Safety

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Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	read a scenario and explain the hazards and the safest choices at a river.
KEY IDEA	Rivers can look calm but still be unsafe. **Think first**, ask an adult and look for hazards.
WORKED MODEL	Cause: heavy rain upstream. Effect: higher, faster, colder water. Safe choice: stay out and follow local advice.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ find hazards in a text
- ☐ explain a safe decision
- ☐ give safety advice

READ **A Day at the River**

Maya's family is camping next to a river on a hot day. The water looks calm and cool. Maya's cousin Leo wants to jump in from the bank. "It looks fine!" he says.

Maya sees a sign that says **Strong currents**. She also sees a log floating past, and the water is too muddy to see the bottom. "Wait," says Maya. "Let's ask Uncle Ravi."

Uncle Ravi says the river is not safe for swimming today. "It rained a lot last week, so the water is fast and cold," he says. The kids stay on the bank and play a game on the grass instead.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. What did the sign at the river say?

2. Name two things that made the river unsafe.

3. Why did Maya tell Leo to wait?

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

4. What could Leo do instead of jumping in?

5. Why is it dangerous to jump into water if you cannot see the bottom?

C. REASON AND EVALUATE — CHALLENGE

6. Write one rule you would add to the camp rules for rivers.

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain hazards and safe choices at a river.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Scenario 2: A Day at the Beach

Year 3–4 · Rip Scenario

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Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	read a scenario and explain what went wrong, what went right and what to do in a rip.
KEY IDEA	Good decisions **before** you enter the water keep you safe. If something goes wrong, stay calm and call for help.
WORKED MODEL	Decision: swim near the rocks, far from the flags. Result: caught in a rip. Safe action: float, signal, let a lifeguard help.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ explain cause and effect ☐ judge decisions ☐ describe a safe response

READ **A Day at the Beach**

Sam and Priya arrive at the beach after lunch. The red and yellow flags are far down the beach. “It’s too far to walk,” says Sam. “Let’s swim near the rocks.” The water looks calm there, and fewer waves are breaking.

Soon Sam feels the water pulling him away from the beach. He is scared. He remembers what he learned: stay calm, float on his back and wave an arm. He does not try to swim against the water.

Priya does not go in. She runs to the lifeguard tower and shouts for help. A lifeguard grabs a rescue board, paddles out and brings Sam back to the sand. Sam is safe.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. Where were the red and yellow flags?

2. Why should Sam and Priya not have swum near the rocks?

3. What did Sam do that helped keep him safe?

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

4. What did Priya do? Why did she not swim out to Sam?

5. What should Sam and Priya have done at the start of the day?

C. REASON AND EVALUATE — CHALLENGE

6. In your own words, what is a rip?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain what to do in a rip and how to get help safely.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Water and Country

Year 3–4 · First Nations Perspectives

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Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Acknowledgement: We acknowledge the Traditional Owners of the lands and waters on which we live and learn. We pay our respects to Elders past and present.

LEARNING INTENTION	describe how First Nations knowledge of water and Country can support safe choices.
KEY IDEA	**Country** means the land, waters, plants, animals and stories that belong together. For tens of thousands of years, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples have cared for rivers, lakes and sea Country.
WORKED MODEL	Elders know when the tides come and where it is safe. They share this knowledge. We listen and show respect.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ explain ‘Country’ ☐ describe how knowledge keeps people safe ☐ show respect for water places

READ **Caring for Water Country**

Water is an important part of Country. Many Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities know the rivers, lakes and sea very well. Elders pass on knowledge about the water, such as when the tides come in, where the water is safe and where to be careful.

Today, many communities share this knowledge in their own ways and look after water places together with rangers, schools and councils. We can show respect by listening to local Elders, following signs and local advice, and looking after the water and the plants and animals that live there.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. What does ‘Country’ include?

2. How do Elders help people stay safe around water?

B. REFLECT

3. Write one way you can show respect for water places.

4. What is one question you would like to ask a local Elder or Traditional Owner about water near your school?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain water and Country respectfully.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Reach, Throw, Don't Go

Year 3–4 · Safe Rescue and Calling 000

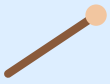
Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	explain how to help someone in trouble in the water without putting yourself in danger.
KEY IDEA	If someone is in trouble in the water, **never jump in**. Shout for help, then **reach** or **throw** something that floats. Call 000 or ask an adult to call.
WORKED MODEL	A friend is in trouble in the deep end. I shout 'Help!', throw a float, keep watching and do not go in.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ order the steps
- ☐ choose Reach, Throw or Don't Go
- ☐ say what to tell 000



REACH

Use a stick, pole or towel while staying on land.



THROW

Throw a ring, rope or anything that floats.



DON'T GO

Do not enter the water to rescue someone.

A. PUT THE STEPS IN ORDER — write 1 to 4

- ☐ Reach or throw something that floats
- ☐ Shout for help and tell an adult
- ☐ Keep watching until help comes
- ☐ Call 000 or ask an adult to call

B. CALLING 000 — what to say

Call 000 (Triple Zero). Tell them:

I need an _____

I am at _____

Someone is _____

C. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

1. A friend is struggling in a pool and you are on the edge. Which would you choose: Reach, Throw or Don't Go? Why?

2. Why is 'Don't Go' the safest choice?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain how to help safely and how to call 000.

Circle one: independently · with one reminder · with support

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Summer Safety: Sun, Heat and Pool Rules

Year 3–4 · Stay Safe This Summer

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Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	explain how to protect yourself from sun and heat and follow safe pool rules.
KEY IDEA	The Australian summer sun is strong. **Slip, Slop, Slap, Seek, Slide** protects our skin. Pool rules keep everyone safe.
WORKED MODEL	Rule: no running on the wet pool deck. Why: wet tiles are slippery and a fall could cause an injury.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ name the five sun-safe actions
- ☐ sort safe and unsafe actions
- ☐ explain why rules matter

SLIP	SLOP	SLAP	SEEK	SLIDE
on sun-protective clothing	on SPF 30 or higher sunscreen	on a broad-brimmed hat	shade	on sunglasses

A. SORT — tick Safe or Unsafe for each action

Running on the wet pool deck	☐ Safe	☐ Unsafe	Listening to the lifeguard or instructor	☐ Safe	☐ Unsafe
Pushing a friend into the water	☐ Safe	☐ Unsafe	Swimming alone	☐ Safe	☐ Unsafe
Putting on more sunscreen after swimming	☐ Safe	☐ Unsafe	Diving into the shallow end	☐ Safe	☐ Unsafe

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

1. Why do we put sunscreen on again after swimming?

2. Choose one pool rule. Say why it keeps people safe.

C. THINK ABOUT IT

3. Write one more rule for your school's pool.

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can protect myself from the sun and follow safe pool rules.

Circle one: independently · with one reminder · with support

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My Family Water Safety Plan

Year 3–4 · Practical Activity

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Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	plan how a family can stay safe in, on and around water this summer.
KEY IDEA	A plan made **before** summer helps families stay safe. Share it with your family. You can leave out personal details if you prefer.
WORKED MODEL	Place: beach. Rule: swim between the flags. Who watches: Dad and Mia. Emergency: call 000.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ list water places and rules
- ☐ plan who watches
- ☐ list emergency steps

A. WHERE WILL WE SWIM THIS SUMMER?

1. Circle the places your family might visit:

pool · beach · river · lake · dam · backyard pool · boat or kayak

2. The place we will visit first: _____

B. OUR SAFETY RULES

Who will watch the water: _____

Our three safety rules: _____

Lifejackets, hats and sunscreen we need: _____

C. IN AN EMERGENCY

Emergency number: 000 Meeting place: _____

We will reach or throw, not go. Who knows how? _____

Adults who know first aid or CPR: _____

D. HOME POOL OR SPA CHECK — tick if it applies (leave blank if you have none)

- ☐ The fence and gate are in good condition
- ☐ The gate is always closed and latched
- ☐ Toys are removed from the pool area
- ☐ Chairs and climbables are away from the fence

3. What is the most important part of our plan, and why?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can make a family water safety plan.

Circle one: independently · with one reminder · with support

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Design a Water Safety Sign

Year 3–4 · Design and Explain

Aussie Primary Academy | Australian & Victorian Curriculum | Learn, Analyse and Practise

Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	design a clear water safety sign using colour, shape and a short message.
KEY IDEA	Safety signs use **colour and shape** so people can understand them fast. Words are short and clear.
WORKED MODEL	Sign: red circle with a slash and a diver. Message: No diving. Why: the water is shallow and diving can cause serious injury.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ choose the right sign type ☐ use few clear words ☐ explain my design choices



PROHIBITED
Stop! Do not do this.



WARNING
Be careful. There is a hazard.



MUST DO
You must do this.



SAFE / HELP
This is safe or shows help.

A. CHOOSE YOUR SIGN

Hazard or rule: _____

Sign type (circle): Prohibited · Warning · Must do · Safe / help

B. DESIGN — draw your sign, then write your message

Draw your sign here

C. EXPLAIN YOUR DESIGN

1. Write your sign message in 5 words or fewer.

2. Why did you choose these colours and this shape?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can design a clear water safety sign.

Circle one: independently · with one reminder · with support

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My Swimming Skills Tracker

Year 3–4 · Pool Program

Aussie Primary Academy | Australian & Victorian Curriculum | Learn, Analyse and Practise

Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	reflect on my swimming and water safety skills and set a goal.
KEY IDEA	Everyone learns at their own pace. Use the tracker to see what you can do now and what you want to practise next.
WORKED MODEL	Skill: float on my back. Date: 3 Nov. I can do it: getting there. Goal: float calmly for longer.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ rate my skills honestly ☐ set a goal ☐ explain how I improved

A. MY SKILLS — tick one box for each skill (your teacher or instructor will tell you which to try)

	Not yet	Getting there	I can do it	Date
Enter the water safely (step or slide in)	○	○	○	_____
Blow bubbles and put my face in the water	○	○	○	_____
Float on my back with help or on my own	○	○	○	_____
Float on my front	○	○	○	_____
Kick on my back and on my front	○	○	○	_____
Glide from the wall	○	○	○	_____
Swim 10 to 25 metres on my front or back	○	○	○	_____
Climb out of the water safely	○	○	○	_____
Put on a lifejacket the right way	○	○	○	_____
Raise an arm and call for help	○	○	○	_____

B. MY GOAL

1. The skill I want to practise next is

2. One thing I can do now that I could not do before:

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can reflect on my skills and set a goal.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

Teacher or instructor comment: _____

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Vocabulary

Year 3–4 · Key Terms

Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	use water safety words accurately in speaking and writing.
KEY IDEA	Using the **right word** makes your message clear. Read each definition, then use the word in your own sentence.
WORKED MODEL	Lifeguard: "The lifeguard blew the whistle when a swimmer drifted outside the flags."

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ read each definition ☐ use a term in a sentence ☐ match a word to its meaning

Hazard
Something that could hurt you.

Lifeguard
A trained person who watches swimmers and helps in an emergency.

Patrolled beach
A beach where lifeguards are on duty between the red and yellow flags.

Rip
Fast water that pulls away from the beach.

Current
Water that moves in one direction, like in a river.

Float
To lie on top of the water and rest.

Lifejacket
A jacket that helps you float. Wear one on boats and when rock fishing.

Supervise
To watch carefully so someone stays safe.

Emergency
A dangerous situation that needs help right away.

Triple Zero (000)
The phone number to call for police, fire or ambulance in an emergency.

Country
The land, waters, plants, animals and stories that belong together for First Nations peoples.

Slip, Slop, Slap, Seek, Slide
Five ways to protect yourself from the sun.

A. APPLY

1. Choose three words and use each one in a sentence of your own.

.....

.....

.....

2. Match. Write the word that fits each meaning: **lifeguard · rip · supervise · emergency**

a) trained person who watches swimmers _____

b) fast water that pulls away from shore _____

c) watch carefully _____

d) a dangerous situation needing help _____

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can use water safety vocabulary accurately.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Teacher Copy — Answers and Teaching Support

Year 3–4 · Teacher Copy

Australian Curriculum (HPE v9.0): AC9HP4P10 · AC9HP4P08 · AC9HP4M05 · AC9HP4M01 | **Victorian Curriculum F–10 V2.0:** Swimming and Water Safety

Accept equivalent responses when the student applies the targeted skill accurately and justifies the choice. Not for student use.

COMPLETE ANSWER KEY

Page 4 — Where Do We Swim in Australia?

1. Accept any two: pool, beach, river, lake, dam. 2. River A (fast water), Beach B (rips), Dam C (very cold, deep water). 3. Personal response: accept a real local place with one hazard and one safe choice. 4. Accept any general rule, for example never swim alone, swim where an adult is watching, check for signs.

Pages 5–7 — Hazard Spotter (marker key)

1 swimmer outside the flags · 2 rip current · 3 no hat, shirt or shade in the sun · 4 diving or jumping head first into shallow water · 5 rock fishing without a lifejacket on wet rocks · 6 board or surf craft in the swimming area · 7 (safe) lifeguard tower.

Page 5 (Support): accept the word bank match above. 'Unsafe because': 1 lifeguards may not see or reach them; 2 it can pull people away from shore; 3 sunburn or heat illness; 4 hitting the bottom can cause serious injury; 5 waves can wash a person off the rocks; 6 a board can hit swimmers. Marker 7: lifeguard tower; lifeguards watch the water and can help. Q1: accept any sensible beach rule.

Page 6 (At Standard): accept hazard names, risks and fixes such as: 1 swim between the flags; 2 stay out of the rip, ask a lifeguard; 3 hat, shirt, sunscreen, shade; 4 enter feet first and check the depth; 5 lifejacket and avoid wet rocks; 6 surf craft stay outside the flags. Q1: accept a reasoned choice (commonly 2 or 4). Q2: lifeguard tower: lifeguards watch, give advice and rescue.

Page 7 (Extension): accept reasoned rankings that consider likelihood and seriousness (a typical top group: rip, diving into shallow water, swimming outside the flags). Q1 accept combinations such as a rip plus swimming outside the flags, or a board in the swim zone plus a crowded area. Q2: flags mark the patrolled area and warn of dangers, but they do not remove every risk (rips can still occur, people must follow rules, lifeguards cannot be everywhere).

Page 8 — Beach Safety: Flags, Signs and Rips

1. Swim between these flags; lifeguards are watching. 2. Any two: darker water, foam moving out, a gap in the waves. 3. float, arm. 4. Lifeguards are there to watch and rescue; the flags mark the safest area. 5. Stay at the flags and swim only where lifeguards are watching.

Page 9 — Scenario 1: A Day at the River

1. Strong currents. 2. Any two: a log floating past, muddy water that hides the bottom, strong currents, recent rain (fast and cold). 3. The sign, the log and the muddy water meant it could be unsafe. 4. Stay on the bank and play on the grass, or ask an adult to paddle in the shallows with a lifejacket. 5. Hidden rocks or logs, or shallow water, can cause serious injuries. 6. Accept sensible rules, for example never swim in a river without an adult and a lifejacket.

Page 10 — Scenario 2: A Day at the Beach

1. Far down the beach, away from the rocks. 2. It was away from the flags and lifeguards, and the calm look with fewer waves can show a rip. 3. He stayed calm, floated on his back and waved an arm. 4. She ran to the lifeguard and shouted for help; she did not swim because she could get into trouble too. 5. Walk to the flags and swim between them. 6. A rip is fast water that pulls swimmers away from the beach.

Page 11 — Water and Country

1. Land, waters, plants, animals and stories. 2. They share knowledge about tides and where it is safe or careful. 3. Accept respectful actions: listen to local Elders, follow signs, look after the water. 4. Personal response; accept respectful, specific questions.

Pages 12–13 — Rescue and Summer Safety

Page 12: Order: 2, 1, 4, 3 (shout for help; reach or throw; call 000; keep watching). Accept 2, 4, 1, 3. Q1 Reach or Throw. Q2 you stay safe and the person is still helped.

Page 13: Unsafe: running, pushing, swimming alone, diving into the shallow end. Safe: listening to the lifeguard, more sunscreen after swimming. Q1 water and sweat wash sunscreen off. Q2 accept a rule with a reason.

Pages 14–17 — Application pages

Page 14: personal response. Check that places, rules, a person watching, emergency number 000 and at least one safety rule are included.
Page 15: accept a clear message with a suitable colour and shape (red prohibits, yellow warns, blue says must do, green shows safe or help), and an explanation that links colour, shape and words.

Page 16: self-assessment, no right answers. Use it to discuss goals with students. **Page 17:** matching: a) lifeguard, b) rip, c) supervise, d) emergency.

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TEACHER CHECK AND NEXT STEP

- ☐ Identifies the target safety idea accurately and gives evidence.
- ☐ Applies it independently to a new water situation and explains the choice.

Next step: model one hard item, complete one together, then repeat independently in a new context.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS / WATCH OUT

- Calm water is not always safe water. Rips and currents can look calm.
- Being a good swimmer does not make it safe to swim anywhere. Conditions, supervision and local knowledge matter.
- Inflatable pool toys and floaties are not lifesaving devices.
- A rescue is not the same as jumping in. Reach, Throw, Don't Go keeps the rescuer safe.
- First Nations knowledge is diverse. Avoid generalising across nations; use local sources where possible.

EXTENSION AND RE-TEACH

Re-teach: model one item aloud, complete one together, then ask the student to explain an independent correction.

Extension: write a short persuasive letter to a local council or swimming pool recommending one water safety improvement, using two facts from the scenarios as evidence.

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Marking Rubric

Year 3–4 · Teacher Use

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Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

SIMPLE 4-LEVEL RUBRIC — circle the level that best matches the student's work

CRITERION	4 · EXTENDING	3 · AT STANDARD	2 · DEVELOPING	1 · BEGINNING
Water environments and hazards	Names places and explains hazards with detail. ○	Names places and describes hazards. ○	Names places with limited hazards. ○	Little accurate understanding. ○
Spotting and explaining risk	Finds all hazards and explains why and how to fix them. ○	Finds most hazards and gives reasons and fixes. ○	Finds some hazards with general reasons. ○	Finds few hazards. ○
Safe choices and getting help	Explains Reach, Throw, Don't Go, flags and 000 with reasons. ○	Explains flags, rescue and 000 accurately. ○	Names some safe actions. ○	Names one safe action. ○
First Nations perspectives	Explains water and Country respectfully, linked to safety. ○	Describes water and Country accurately. ○	Partly describes water and Country. ○	Little understanding. ○
Application: plan, sign, tracker	Creative, accurate, detailed and well justified. ○	Clear, accurate and complete. ○	Partly complete or partly accurate. ○	Incomplete. ○
Vocabulary and communication	Uses key terms precisely in clear writing. ○	Uses key terms correctly. ○	Uses some key terms. ○	Rarely uses key terms. ○

SCORE ____ / 24 20–24 Extending · 15–19 At Standard · 10–14 Developing · 6–9 Beginning

Teacher comment: _____

Student next step: _____

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